

Chapter Four: Academic Fiction

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A map, as of the 1st March 2015, of Chapter Four of [the book I am slowly working on](#). This chapter primarily focuses on Percival Everett's *Erasure*.

Chapter Four: Academic Fiction

First chapter on legitimation

Everett's insider status

Summary of *Erasure*

Erasure as metafiction

Subject position of author

High Theory references

Disparaging towards High Theory/postmodernist approach

Resorts to "common sense"

Except that Ellison is a postmodern writer

Book is problematic as both post-postmodern and "post-racial"

Sous rature situated at co-generative emergence of post-struct

and pomo

Inner parody is mise-en-abyme

Thus, entire text is parody

Leads to destabilisation of legitimation

Sincerity

Sincerity vs. authenticity

Complications of psychoanalysis

Sincerity as a check on future action

Trust in present performance of avowal

Empirical verification of future action

Matrix of authenticity

Authentic sincerity / Sincere authenticity

Inauthentic sincerity / Sincere inauthenticity

Authentic insincerity / Insincere authenticity

Inauthentic insincerity / Insincere authenticity

Shift back towards a focus on sincerity in art

Groundhog Day as example

In fiction, possibly defined by Wallace's manifesto

documents

Narrative that postmodern literature is parasitic on

sincerity

Adam Kelly and "Octet"

Impossibility of a "sincere author" within a text

Instead: persuasion/promise of necessity of

composition

Writing Under *Erasure*, Sincerity and Legitimation

Sincerity is opposed to strategy (rhetoric)

Strategy dishonestly spends future reputational capital of

sincerity

Strategy depends on belief in foreknowledge of reception

Everett's deployment of irony is sincere

Subject matter is ironic

So, irony, which is usually strategic, is congruous w/ subject

matter

Hyper-focalization on race but readings take post-racial

ambition

Problems of post- identities

Despite being a book that features an academic, academia hard to place

Mise-en-abyme parallel: Gimbel and Ellison

Parody and nested double-negation effect

Inner narrative nested within ironic outer

Self-criticism

Prize culture

James English

Represented within the novel

Erasure wants readers who are educated and trained

It also wants to disparage that reading

Climb a ladder and then discard it

Time to grow up, such works say, time to leave school

Such works are post-academic fictions